

"5 Advisor-e Steps.jpg"

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It provides a clear, easily digestible visual roadmap showing exactly how their raw data translates into actionable business experiments and ongoing feedback.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It acts as a visual aid to easily communicate the journey and value ladder of the advisory process, illustrating the progression from basic accounting software (Xero) up through advanced advisory services.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Visual learners, clients needing a high-level overview of the advisory relationship, and advisors who need a straightforward graphic to pitch their step-by-step methodology.

How to use the material in practice

1. Begin at the bottom step with **Compilation Verification**, explaining that the first goal is to use tools like Xero to get the data in, ensuring it is "clean" and timely.
2. Move to **Assimilation**, showing how to use tools like Spotlight to render the data so it is easy to view and digest.
3. Transition to **Interpretation** (the first Advisor-e step), teaching the client to recognize the difference between correlation and causation in their numbers.
4. Climb to **Application**, where the advisor and client determine the next business "experiment" based on the interpreted data.
5. Conclude at the top step with **Observation**, committing to "stay in the loop" to monitor the results of the experiment.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** What software tool is associated with the Compilation Verification step?

A: Xero is used to get the data clean and timely.

2. **Q:** What is the primary goal of the Assimilation step?

A: To render the data so it is easy to view and digest, often using a tool like Spotlight.

3. **Q:** What key analytical skill is highlighted in the Interpretation step?

A: Recognizing correlation versus causation.

4. **Q:** What is the specific action taken during the Application step?

A: Determining the next 'experiment' for the business.

5. **Q:** How does the staircase describe the final Observation step?

A: It requires the advisor to "stay in the loop".

"5_Steps_in_Advisore_Staircase.mp4"

Benefits

- **How it helps the business owner:** It forces them to pay attention to critical areas of their business—including potential areas of weakness—through structured meetings, preventing them from constantly managing by crisis. It also lets them know what the meetings will be like in advance.
- **How it helps the advisor:** It clarifies the varying levels of skill or competence needed within a team at each stage, provides a structured process for presenting to clients, and offers distinct pricing options based on the level of service delivered.
- **Who it may be suitable for:** Accounting and advisory firms looking to build tiered service packages, assign specific team members to different advisory stages, or transition clients from basic compliance to structured coaching.

How to use the material in practice

1. **Compilation Verification:** Start by gathering the client's data and ensuring it is tight and accurate.
2. **Assimilation:** Turn the tight data into concise summary reports (KPIs). Deliver these reports based on the client's price point, such as via a Camtasia video voiceover, Skype, or a face-to-face meeting.
3. **Interpretation:** Wrap the data around management meetings by looking for trends and knowing which data matters.
4. **Application:** Implement a "light fundamentals program" to provide structure. Use the provided templates to run structured meetings focused on six key focus areas, deciding exactly what the business owner will change.
5. **Observation:** Act from a coaching perspective by staying in the feedback loop, determining an action plan based on the new information, and redirecting the client as necessary.

Common Q&A

1. **Q:** How does the staircase model help with team delegation? **A:** It identifies the different levels of skill or competence required at each stage, allowing an advisor to use different team members for different roles depending on the client.
2. **Q:** How can this process be used to structure pricing? **A:** It provides options around pricing by breaking down services; for instance, a basic package might only include compilation and assimilation, while higher price points include interpretation, application, and face-to-face delivery.
3. **Q:** What happens if you skip structure during the Application phase? **A:** Without structure, you are likely to constantly deal with crisis points, merely jumping from one issue to another in response to the figures.
4. **Q:** What is the purpose of the "light fundamentals program"? **A:** It forces the client to pay attention to six key focus areas (often areas of weakness) through structured meetings and provides the templates needed to run them confidently.
5. **Q:** How can the initial data reports be delivered to clients? **A:** They can be recorded on Camtasia with a voiceover and sent as a video, or delivered via Skype or face-to-face.
6. **Q:** What is the advisor's role during the final Observation step? **A:** The advisor acts from a coaching perspective to ensure the client stays in the feedback loop and to redirect them if their action plan goes off course.